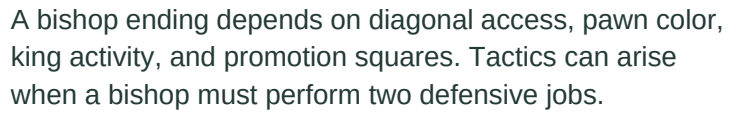


Bishop-ending decisions

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Trace the bishop's line to each target and identify pawns that can break its coverage or force it to move.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: bishop on f5. Check for tactical protection.

Previous move: 47.Bf5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

47...g3+ 48. Kxh3 g2 49. Be4+ Kxe4

47...g3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **48.Kxh3**.

48...g2 The pawn moves from g3 to g2. Recorded reply: **49.Be4+**.

49...Kxe4 The king captures the bishop on e4.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

Same-colored and opposite-colored bishop endings have different tendencies, but neither label replaces calculation of the actual pawn races.